THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES
Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.
They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 20

MASSACHUSETTS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Massachusetts's family courts and child-welfare system.

116

MASSACHUSETTS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 165 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF	COUNTY LABELS REPORTED	COMPILED BY
OCTOBER 27, 2026	**27 SUBMITTED**	**MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM**

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · MASSACHUSETTS

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Massachusetts. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Patricia brady

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MEDFORD MA · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"This is a very well known offender in Massachusetts she runs a business profiteering on children acting as both a guardian ad litem as well as expert witness and supervisor. I have a lot of information on her as well as records where she had ex parte Communications with the father asked the father if he was happy with the report while collecting money as well as concealing evidence including felony illegal wiretapping"*

> *"Delayed finishing and completing GAL report for over a year Took over a year and a half to complete a GAL investigation recommended that there be no contact between father and daughter because of the seriousness of allegations recommended that the boys have transition plan with Dad and parenting time as well as family therapy."*

> *"Patricia Brady (Visitation Center) – Managed the supervised visitation services in my case. Supervisors who documented concerns regarding the children's welfare and caregiving arrangements were later removed from the case, and I was not provided with clear or consistent explanations for those decisions."*

> *"She testified against me in custody proceedings back 2015 . I never met this individual nor did she ever witness me with my daughter. She is an awful person."* ESSEX

> *"Locked my kid in room. Supports who ever pays her bill. Does not look out for best interest of children"*

> *"Spoke to both parents, talked to 3 children, mother made false allegations and she knew and did nothing"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-patricia-brady/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Frances M. Giordano **CONTINUED 1 / 2**

JUDGE · ESSEX COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"On 01/2024 when I first filed the contempt , She found my son's father in contempt and said he had to return him for parenting time. She ordered me to start therapy becauee they were saying that I wanted to kill my children etc. then she said I'll see you back in court in a month. So we went back and we were supposed to see her that day. I was handed a complaint for contempt and modification in custody by my son's father's attorney. I told the clerk I wanted to continue the contempt hearing that day because I now felt uncomfortable about all these lies and false accusations against me that I was just given by the other party. They refused to allow me to reschedule and on top of that they waited until almost 4pm when the court was about to close to have us called. When we got to the courtroom. Judge Giordano supposedly had to leave right at 4 for a family emergency. So we had judge Manisha Bhatt who has never presided over a hearing as a judge until this day when the court was about to close(keeping in mind I asked for a continuance so I could obtain counsel around 9am that morning and sat there the entire day after being told NO! Judge Bhatt was just nominated in December 2023 and she was now making this huge life changing decision for my case which ruined my world. She again wouldn't let me continue the case and I asked her and told her I needed an attorney because they're now accusing me of things that are not true. She didn't care and proceeded with the contempt hearing. She overruled judge Giordanos findings that dad was in contempt and she said now he's not in contempt and here we are 28 months later and I've never had parenting time with my son. He was just erased from our lives in a blink of an eye. I'm not even sure she was legally allowed to to rule on my"*
>
> CONTINUES ON THE NEXT CARD

> FAMILY COMMENT CONTINUED
>
> *"care. She was in the court room that entire day sitting with judge Giordano and she was training. I don't know how things like this are allowed to happen."*

> *"Denied motions rushed to judgment told me that she doesn't care what's happened in the criminal court"* ESSEX

> *"Ignored evidence and decided to rule on false allegations. Lost time with children."*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Frances M. Giordano CONTINUED 2 / 2

JUDGE · ESSEX COUNTY · 5 SUBMISSIONS

> *"Evidence and testimony was ignored by the judge"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-frances-m-giordano/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Carla A. Salvucci CONTINUED 1 / 2

JUDGE · MIDDLESEX PROBATE AND FAMILY COURT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"In my counter-complaint for modification and my pre-trial memo, I outlined very specific concerns relating to alcohol and substance abuse by my ex-wife and her family, and also illegal firearm possession, including around our daughter. I mentioned that some of this evidence was publicly available on their Instagram accounts. Opposing counsel classified my concerns as "baseless allegations" in two written filings. Then during the pre-trial hearing, opposing counsel stated: "I don't think this is the time or the place to get into details about what he thinks of mother's various family members." Judge Carla A. Salvucci gave absolutely ZERO push back to opposing counsel, showed no concern for the safety or well being of my daughter at any point during the hearing, and even dismissed my daughter saying multiple times on a video call that she "needs to run away" as not being concerning because "three year-olds say things." Carla Salvucci has to this day, completely ignored a motion to dismiss based on subject matter jurisdiction (sitting unanswered on the docket since August 2025), which outlines how my ex-wife established Massachusetts residency of our daughter through blatant, provable fraud. In addition, during a pre-trial hearing, she allowed opposing counsel, Wendy Overbaugh Hickey, to characterize my concerns about my ex-wife's family abusing alcohol, marijuana, and other substances (including around my daughter), as well as illegal weapons possession, as "the way father feels about mother's family" without so much as a word of push back. Carla Salvucci was more concerned about my income, than she was with my daughter's safety."*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Carla A. Salvucci CONTINUED 2 / 2

JUDGE · MIDDLESEX PROBATE AND FAMILY COURT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Has denied virtually every motion I filed, including the December 2025 emergency motion to vacate the June 16, 2025 temporary suspension order despite attached police reports proving Father's perjury, denied Short Order of Notice and immediate relief on my April 2026 emergency motion following my son's hospitalization (hearing delayed until June 22, 2026), issued a factually incorrect handwritten denial on May 1, 2026 claiming the GAL report was due April 30, and refused to clarify or enforce my basic communication rights despite Father's own claim of access."*

> *"She suspended my parenting time on 10/1/24 for no reason."* ESSEX

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-carla-a-salvucci/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Lawrence Army Jr.

JUDGE · WORCESTER PROBATE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Judge Army switched custody overnight to my abusive ex husband who my children had been refusing to go with out of fear. When I brought forth a conflict of interest with the GAL and myself (we worked together, I contracted her husband for work for years and her daughter was a student in my school and worked directly with my children) he then removed all contact between me and my children without findings. Within weeks he aburuptly "retired" effectively leaving my family stuck in this situation without another judge. 5 months later it was announced by the state that he was found guilty of misconduct and was fined and no longer allowed to practice law, however, over a year later his decisions still stand. We finally have a new judge and an upcoming trial but regardless of what happens the damage has been done and there is no recourse for my family and my children who have suffered greatly through all of this. Happy healthy honors student teenagers who were very involved in activities are now failing, having severe physical and mental health issues, no longer participate in activites, are self harming, not adeuately nourished, constant DCF involvement for neglect and failure to mainta"* HAMPDEN COUNTRY FAMILY PROBATE COURT

> *"Came in from no were kangaroo judge just fir my hearing . Later found he signed off before trial custody from mother to father. He's very corrupt . He was involved lots of playoffs his own contempt of court in his divorce alimony and his own custody stealing his kids ..women hater ."*

> *"He took away my custodial rights after a false allegations"* HAMPDEN

> *"Will not hear past nor see any evidence"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-lawrence-army-jr/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Manisha Bhatt

JUDGE · MIDDLESEX PROBATE AND FAMILY COURT NORTH - LOWELL · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She's currently the judge over seeing our case. So far, she seems fair and kind. She listened to both sides and asked appropriate questions. She didn't seem to show favoritism towards either side, which honestly, is great. Family court in MA has caused me such anxiety due to my former spouse using it to as a means of control and harm towards our children. However, I have hope after our interactions with her as our judge."*

> *"Judge Manisha Bhatt – Currently presides over my ongoing case. She denied requests to hear testimony from a witness with firsthand knowledge of the children's living situation, allowed the children's father and guardian to obtain Brazilian passports and travel internationally with the children over my objection, and denied my request for regular weekly phone contact with my daughters."*

> *"She's the one who allowed my son to just not come home. She never ordered anything there was no due process and it was on a contempt that I filed against my sons father a week after he stopped coming to my house."*

> *"Haven't seen children in two years, contempts were not taken seriously and there were no consequences and found not guilty for continuously violating orders!"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-manisha-bhatt/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Maureen Monks

JUDGE · COUNTY NOT LISTED · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"The judge denied a continuance despite missing evidence, imposed restrictions neither parent requested, and justified them with unsupported safety concerns that contradicted the GAL's findings."*

> *"Original judge from 2020 supported seriousness of sexual abuse allegations and most protective of children. She was replaced in 2023 by Christine Anthony who was replace by Elena tier in 2026"*

> *"Denied a gatekeeper motion"* MIDDLESEX

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ma-maureen-monks/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

MASSACHUSETTS AT A GLANCE.

Across 116 Massachusetts families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST	WENT PRO SE
165	**$136,300**	**18**	**54.3%**
109 of 116 families reported child counts	median across 46 families reporting 3+ categories	of parenting time	63 of 116 who answered; 43 of 116 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTY LABELS REPORTED
116	**1.5**	**109 of 116**	**27**

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- **NO TRIAL.**
- **NO QUESTIONING.**
- **NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.**

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Massachusetts families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF MASSACHUSETTS FAMILY COURT

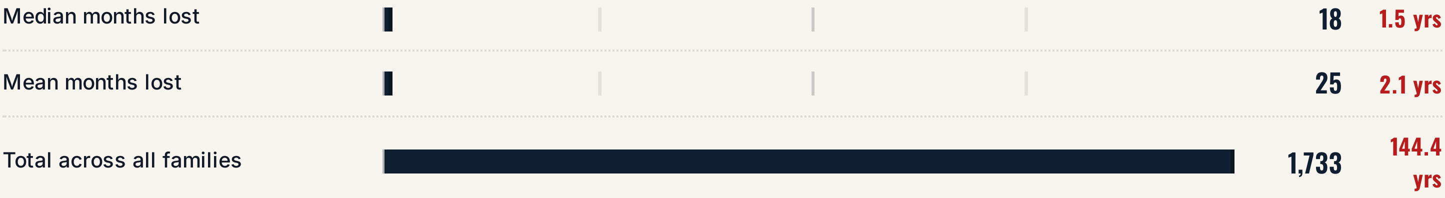
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	59	$45,000	$90,658	$5,348,845
Lost Wages	44	$27,500	$259,739	$11,428,500
Other Court Fees	32	$2,000	$4,870	$155,845
Therapy / Evaluations	28	$2,000	$4,958	$138,825
Reunification Services	26	$500	$4,782	$124,338
GAL Fees	40	$7,000	$10,960	$438,407
Asset Loss [1]	33	$40,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (46 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$136,300	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($40,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · MASSACHUSETTS

Most families documenting in Massachusetts are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	63	58%
Not provided	17	16%
Case closed: within last 2 years	11	10%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	8	7%
Active case: progress being made	7	6%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	49	43%
Both Family Court and CPS	44	39%
Unknown	9	8%
CPS Only	7	6%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)	5	4%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	33	30%
3 – 5 years	26	24%
5 – 10 years	23	21%
Over 10 years	16	15%
6 months – 1 year	4	4%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	31	27%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	27	23%
50/50 Joint	27	23%
Full Custody	16	14%
Children in Foster Care	6	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Middlesex	25	27%
Essex	13	14%
Norfolk	8	9%
Worcester	7	8%
Bristol	6	7%
Suffolk	6	7%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	37	32%
High Conflict Divorce	23	20%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	18	16%
Other	14	12%
Other: (Short answer)	6	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — MASSACHUSETTS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Massachusetts comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> "
>
> *False allegations by my practicing attorney wife in Norfolk County Massachusetts - who knows all the players in the courthouse - had me removed and took my three children 15 months ago. The judges and CPS have done nothing to correct it even with proof that the allegations are [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

> Financially hundreds of thousands over the years emotionally much greater but not as much as my children we have timed calls and visits and they beg for more time they hide with the phone and don't want to leave the visits it kills me judge mary black and bridgette garbaly james [...]
>
> **— MASSACHUSETTS PARENT · MICHAEL**

MORE VOICES FROM MASSACHUSETTS

> Destroyed and ripped apart a closely bonded family even causing bad health and lord knows what in future, this country, all of us should be ashamed our children are being trafficked and traumatized
>
> **— JODI**

> Ruined their one and only childhood. Turned their head on GAL reporting and the kids, myself reporting abuse.
>
> **— MICHELLE**

> Destroyed a hardworking close loving family I have lost Everything suffering ptsd The Children are in danger
>
> **— LIZ**

> They placed the rights of a man to abuse his family over the rights a mother and her children have to safety.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> They have abused children who had already been traumatized by their parent who abused them and their mother and then they were ripped away from a protective parent without notice based on lies and placed with an abuser. Everyone, including DCF has advocated for them to return to [...]
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Destroyed my kids life is and mine i never got to raise my kids so me being a parent was extinct
>
> **— MICHELLE**

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The family court system has destroyed my child's life destroyed my life and helped my ex abuse myself and my son.*
>
> — GABRIELLE

The system destroyed a happy and close family without valid reason and caused tremendous trauma and damage to multiple people all based on false allegations all for financial gain

— JODI

Destroyed my children, her alienation has driven a wedge with my oldest but lies to all my children and plays the victim, while financially trying to ruin me, my oldest she put on Prozac and put her in mental hospitals and the doctors and courts allowed it, horrible abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

False allegations ruined and continuing to ruin my life. Job affected due to mother of child's direct involvement. Evidence means nothing in family court. Truth holds no value. The "judgement" and "finding of facts" have nothing to do with the child, at all.. but goes on and on [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Teixeira didn't just take the lives of my children, she reached through time and also stole who they could have been.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stripped us of everything in order to keep us stuck in the legal system game

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"To give you an idea of what the last two years have looked like for me:Total Financial Loss: Lost my career and all savings due to false allegations.Restricted Contact: My relationship with my 3-year-old son is limited to video calls that are intentionally ended within [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole shared love between a mother and her children who deeply love each other. They have caused so much mental trauma for both mother and children that its to the point of irreversible harm to everyone involved.

— ISIS

taken money from me that prevents me from using for my kids when they're with me and not being able to pay my bills and have stolen all the joy in my life and this affects my kids.

— WALTER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed and broken my family to cover up medical malpractice of the hospital that almost killed my child.*
>
> — KRISTY

Haven't seen children in two years. Children have had chronic absenteeism from school and has a false reporting case pending...Bhatt has done nothing to help my children and has further helped isolate them from me!

— NANCY

A system that was supposed to protect my children ignored their voices, separated us for years, and turned motherhood into a battle for survival.

— CARINE

Instead of protecting families, the system enabled ongoing coercive control through litigation, financial abuse, and intimidation, causing lasting emotional harm to my children and enormous personal and financial loss

— CATHERINE

I have fought for years against the false allegations. Its broken my family in ways that hurt. Its weaponized people and children. Its stressful and heartbreaking to live. Our happy days are taken from us so we can deal with stress and fear. Its robbed my children of a free & [...]

— JENNIFER

While I wish I could say "the system failed us," I have learned that the system was never meant to protect myself or my children.

— COURTNEY

Destroyed us. My children are continuing to decline including my middle school honor role student has faked the last 4 semesters of school. My second oldest has SI. My 6yr old bites his nails down to the skin at the base and pulls out his hair in stress.

— JILL

Allowed and helped a father abuse and destroy our beautiful innocent little boy and hurt him every single day of his life.

— GABRIELLE

This system has literally destroyed both my children and myself. Oldest has mental health issues, depression etc. middle has major health issues and is being neglected and younger one is getting the worst as he's not even his child....dcf apparently falsely did the dna as my child [...]

— JENNIFER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system has completely destroyed the life of myself and my child who now requires therapy. I am on the verge of having to sell our home to keep up with attorney fees*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Presented false allegations leading to termination of parental rights. Acted in poor faith. Racially discriminated against young African American mother who fled domestic violence with her infant. Fabricated mental illnesses because parental rights can't be terminated due to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Middlesex Family Court in Massachusetts has absolutely failed my daughter, ignored evidence relating to child safety and well-being (including publicly viewable evidence on social media), allowed provable perjury by both my ex-wife and her attorney (on multiple occasions and in [...]

— MARTIN

When a parent feels unheard in Court, the loss isn't measured in legal orders-it's measured in missed birthdays, unanswered messages, and years you never get back.. decisions I believed were shaped by false allegations in narratives, I could not overcome.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has stripped me of my personal liberty, my sovereignty, my ability to provide for myself and my children, it ripped apart the security and stability for my children and continues to do so relentlessly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Heartbroken, alone, afraid, forever altered

— DANIELLE

Very unbelievable but very true. These people are corrupt criminals!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Concealed conflicts of interest, litigation abuse and the filing of falsified documents in the Middlesex Family and Probate Court resulted in my children losing needed medical care, education and prevented them from having their basic health and safety needs met and effectively [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has forced me to grieve my three living children every single day while they are still alive and deliberately kept from me. Their father abused and tried to destroy me in their presence, yet the court rewards him with total custody and total silence — my oldest has [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Ruined us financially and mentally fighting for my husband to see his kids without his ex playing games to stop it for the past 3+ years*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Corruption of “parenting professional evaluations
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> “DCF and the entities involved dismantled our family—destroying a mother, siblings, and grandmother—and turned a place of education into a hunting ground where children are stalked, held, and taken with police force.”
>
> **— LINDA**

> Judge Ulwick allowed the other side to continue to put in multiple false allegations and emergency orders which she denied over 30 of them. Dragged it out to over 4 years and costed me over $93,000 and over 50 lost days in work.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Traumatized us both,my daughter is 3 she self harms,I don't trust anyone and I'm extremely depressed I'm in bed crying constantly,I had to quit my job bcuz they kept ▯ things say to say with no notice
>
> **— KRISTY**

> The system didn’t just separate me from my children—it prolonged and reinforced the very patterns of control and emotional harm we were already living through.
>
> **— GINA**

> As a scholar in criminal justice, I was horrified once confronted with the ugly realities of family court. The best interests of the children are not prioritized in family court. There is no justice in family court.
>
> **— REBECCA**

> My ex wants to punish me for leaving my dragging out the divorce and the courts are allowing it. My baby was 10 months old when I filed, and the judge granted a known marijuana used 50% of custody despite the fact that he can't take care of a child by himself.
>
> **— POOJA**

> I lost my child due to domestic violence concerns I was the victim but my child got taken from me
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

74 Massachusetts parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — MASSACHUSETTS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Massachusetts families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> False allegations by my practicing attorney wife in Norfolk County Massachusetts - who knows all the players in the courthouse - had me removed and took my three children 15 months ago. The judges and CPS have done nothing to correct it even with proof that the allegations are false.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Destroyed and ripped apart a closely bonded family even causing bad health and lord knows what in future, this country, all of us should be ashamed our children are being trafficked and traumatized
>
> **— JODI**

> Ruined their one and only childhood. Turned their head on GAL reporting and the kids, myself reporting abuse.
>
> **— MICHELLE**

> Destroyed a hardworking close loving family I have lost Everything suffering ptsd The Children are in danger
>
> **— LIZ**

> Financially hundreds of thousands over the years emotionally much greater but not as much as my children we have timed calls and visits and they beg for more time they hide with the phone and don't want to leave the visits it kills me judge mary black and bridgette garbaly james are child abusers I have never done anything and they are profiting off my list time with my children I'm an open book no police record just false accusations with no evidence I have proved my innocence over and over the accusations keep switching
>
> **— MICHAEL**

> They placed the rights of a man to abuse his family over the rights a mother and her children have to safety.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> They have abused children who had already been traumatized by their parent who abused them and their mother and then they were ripped away from a protective parent without notice based on lies and placed with an abuser. Everyone, including DCF has advocated for them to return to my custody without any success or any findings against me. I have a thriving and happy 4 year old in my current marriage and two 14 year old step daughters and yet I can't even speak to my 15 and 16 year old kids who have advocated to come home to me and DCF has a neglect case against their father.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Destroyed my kids life is and mine i never got to raise my kids so me being a parent was extinct
>
> **— MICHELLE**

> The family court system has destroyed my child's life destroyed my life and helped my ex abuse myself and my son.
>
> **— GABRIELLE**

> The system destroyed a happy and close family without valid reason and caused tremendous trauma and damage to multiple people all based on false allegations all for financial gain
>
> **— JODI**

> Destroyed my children, her alienation has driven a wedge with my oldest but lies to all my children and plays the victim, while financially trying to ruin me, my oldest she put on Prozac and put her in mental hospitals and the doctors and courts allowed it, horrible abuse.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> False allegations ruined and continuing to ruin my life. Job affected due to mother of child's direct involvement. Evidence means nothing in family court. Truth holds no value. The "judgement" and "finding of facts" have nothing to do with the child, at all.. but goes on and on and on about how I am a disgusting human being. Both documents revised with fabricated stories authored by judge herself. Blatant lies repeated over and over despite objective evidence to the contrary. GAL report has one line about the child.. that my son and I have a wonderful relationship. The rest is how I am the worst abuser to ever live.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Judge Teixeira didn't just take the lives of my children, she reached through time and also stole who they could have been.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Stripped us of everything in order to keep us stuck in the legal system game
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> "To give you an idea of what the last two years have looked like for me:Total Financial Loss: Lost my career and all savings due to false allegations.Restricted Contact: My relationship with my 3-year-old son is limited to video calls that are intentionally ended within seconds.Severed Bonds: My older children have been completely cut out of their brother's life.Constant Erasure: Every step forward is met with more of my rights and my family being stripped away.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> They stole shared love between a mother and her children who deeply love each other. They have caused so much mental trauma for both mother and children that its to the point of irreversible harm to everyone involved.
>
> **— ISIS**

> taken money from me that prevents me from using for my kids when they're with me and not being able to pay my bills and have stolen all the joy in my life and this affects my kids.
>
> **— WALTER**

> Destroyed and broken my family to cover up medical malpractice of the hospital that almost killed my child.
>
> **— KRISTY**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Haven't seen children in two years. Children have had chronic absenteeism from school and has a false reporting case pending... Bhatt has done nothing to help my children and has further helped isolate them from me!
>
> **— NANCY**

> A system that was supposed to protect my children ignored their voices, separated us for years, and turned motherhood into a battle for survival.
>
> **— CARINE**

> Instead of protecting families, the system enabled ongoing coercive control through litigation, financial abuse, and intimidation, causing lasting emotional harm to my children and enormous personal and financial loss
>
> **— CATHERINE**

> I have fought for years against the false allegations. Its broken my family in ways that hurt. Its weaponized people and children. Its stressful and heartbreaking to live. Our happy days are taken from us so we can deal with stress and fear. Its robbed my children of a free & innocent childhood. The damage & trauma are life changing & ever lasting
>
> **— JENNIFER**

> While I wish I could say "the system failed us," I have learned that the system was never meant to protect myself or my children.
>
> **— COURTNEY**

> Destroyed us. My children are continuing to decline including my middle school honor role student has faked the last 4 semesters of school. My second oldest has SI. My 6yr old bites his nails down to the skin at the base and pulls out his hair in stress.
>
> **— JILL**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Allowed and helped a father abuse and destroy our beautiful innocent little boy and hurt him every single day of his life.

— GABRIELLE

This system has literally destroyed both my children and myself. Oldest has mental health issues, depression etc. middle has major health issues and is being neglected and younger one is getting the worst as he's not even his child….dcf apparently falsely did the dna as my child is of the INDIAN decent and they have separate laws around dcf so they falsely did the dna to protect their asses

— JENNIFER

This system has completely destroyed the life of myself and my child who now requires therapy. I am on the verge of having to sell our home to keep up with attorney fees

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Presented false allegations leading to termination of parental rights. Acted in poor faith. Racially discriminated against young African American mother who fled domestic violence with her infant. Fabricated mental illnesses because parental rights can't be terminated due to homelessness. .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Middlesex Family Court in Massachusetts has absolutely failed my daughter, ignored evidence relating to child safety and well-being (including publicly viewable evidence on social media), allowed provable perjury by both my ex-wife and her attorney (on multiple occasions and in multiple court filings), and has continued to hold onto its fraudulently obtained jurisdiction (of which there is also overwhelming evidence).

— MARTIN

When a parent feels unheard in Court, the loss isn't measured in legal orders-it's measured in missed birthdays, unanswered messages, and years you never get back.. decisions I believed were shaped by false allegations in narratives, I could not overcome.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has stripped me of my personal liberty, my sovereignty, my ability to provide for myself and my children, it ripped apart the security and stability for my children and continues to do so relentlessly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Heartbroken, alone, afraid, forever altered

— DANIELLE

Very unbelievable but very true. These people are corrupt criminals!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Concealed conflicts of interest, litigation abuse and the filing of falsified documents in the Middlesex Family and Probate Court resulted in my children losing needed medical care, education and prevented them from having their basic health and safety needs met and effectively bankrupted our family by charging approximately $1,000,000 in legal fees, even though that was the bulk of our assets.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has forced me to grieve my three living children every single day while they are still alive and deliberately kept from me. Their father abused and tried to destroy me in their presence, yet the court rewards him with total custody and total silence — my oldest has been hospitalized and begs to speak to me, the younger two cannot even advocate for themselves, and I am left wondering how much pain and abandonment they are carrying because they don't understand why their mother disappeared.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined us financially and mentally fighting for my husband to see his kids without his ex playing games to stop it for the past 3+ years

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Corruption of “parenting professional evaluations
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> “DCF and the entities involved dismantled our family—destroying a mother, siblings, and grandmother—and turned a place of education into a hunting ground where children are stalked, held, and taken with police force.”
>
> **— LINDA**

> Judge Ulwick allowed the other side to continue to put in multiple false allegations and emergency orders which she denied over 30 of them. Dragged it out to over 4 years and costed me over $93,000 and over 50 lost days in work.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Traumatized us both,my daughter is 3 she self harms,I don't trust anyone and I'm extremely depressed I'm in bed crying constantly,I had to quit my job bcuz they kept ▯ things say to say with no notice
>
> **— KRISTY**

> The system didn’t just separate me from my children—it prolonged and reinforced the very patterns of control and emotional harm we were already living through.
>
> **— GINA**

> As a scholar in criminal justice, I was horrified once confronted with the ugly realities of family court. The best interests of the children are not prioritized in family court. There is no justice in family court.
>
> **— REBECCA**

> My ex wants to punish me for leaving my dragging out the divorce and the courts are allowing it. My baby was 10 months old when I filed, and the judge granted a known marijuana used 50% of custody despite the fact that he can't take care of a child by himself.
>
> **— POOJA**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I lost my child due to domestic violence concerns I was the victim but my child got taken from me

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

Denied me any contact with my daughter for a year.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

Just because of hearsay it made me and my newborn daughter miss a whole year and then I was homeless and couldn't get a 60 day reunification letter to enter a program for us even though the goal was reunification and for that I lived in a car and couldn't have visits and they moved to adoption . And now I'm awaiting trial . I have never been heard yet by a judge there was no due process.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

The stress I deal with daily. I am a present, active father and spend outside of the court order child support. Which is $578 a week. Financial it crippling me. High credit card debt, etc. I cry most day because I lost my oldest kids and I feel like I could be losing my youngest soon. No one will look at the evidence of her false allegations. I feel like a criminal and prisoner in my own life.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

Years of abusive litigation by my ex -- that has gone unchecked by multiple courts in multiple jurisdictions -- destroyed my employment, savings, and mental health.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

Ripped children apart suddenly from mother who went through domestic violence and protected children for 12 years in her absence. One child rejected mother as court made it difficult on visitations as father continued litigation without serving mother who eventually became prose. Ne child became suicidal and took years to become normal. No justice ever and accountability at court.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> I had to obtain a restraining order due to domestic violence. I was advised by my attorney not to do so until things got out of hand. I am now 18 months into a case that has had seven pre-trials rescheduled due to lack of a GAL completing his investigation, and the other council does not comply with deadlines and orders.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> I'm just starting out in Massachusetts family court. My experience comes from New York State. So far, I can tell that his attorney takes his license and runs rapid with them without evidence. It's a very stressful emotional time.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> We are just numbers not people
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Justice delayed. Justice denied. Judge and opposing counsel and opposing counsel continue to destroy the first five years of childhood despite being granted a year of primary physical custody.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> It has caused my family and myself irreparable harm.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Trapped me and I can't get out after they told me to "file for some self respect". Now me and my kids are low income, destablized from housing, and have had no relief despite repeated pleadings and attempts to protect them.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

> Massive disruption to my son's relationship with my whole family.
>
> **— ANONYMOUS PARENT**

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I fled a domestic situation and moved closer to my family and support system. I'm being penalized for moving and he has been awarded more than he ever had before, and he's now putting on a show of a good father. The GAL said if I moved back closer we could go closer to 50/50. I have been their primary parent their whole lives and the court is trying to force me back towards my abuser, into a harder financial situation (more expensive where he lives/ I moved from), and emotionally into a worse situation away from my support system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has been the worst 7 years of my life. Courts dont listen to domestic abused victims, blame everything on us. Instead of realizing we are protecting they threaten to put us in jail and fine us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ripped me away from my child whom I struggled to have for 10 years and had a rough pregnancy; The child spoke and told drs and others her father hurts her and scared. The system didn’t investigate then gave him custody while my child and home was ripped away and I had an active restraining order on him at the time.

— FAITH

Complete and utter destruction in just minutes. My daughter is in imminent danger, as a district Judge ruled, but family court continues the terror and agony.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The fraudulent racketeering business that wears the mask of "family" court exposes the underbelly of the serpents that have been running financial systems for centuries. It raped, pillaged, attempted murder, and assassination of any shred of happiness or family I would think about having.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has dragged us and extorted us in every way possible referred us into pressured therapy usage etc dictated decisions and wasted time that only parents should be making. Extortion to the absolute fullest while using our kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I was falsely accused by my son’s father for doing drugs and being unfit. I have always had full custody of my other son I have, the system took 2 brothers away from each other. The system stole my 11 year old from me and my family on all false allegations that I have been trying to disprove for over 9 months now.

— RACHEL

It has crippled me financially. It has effected my health I have chronic stress, panic attacks, tinnitus, PTSD, gastric problem, and immune issues. I’ve broken 6 teeth with chronic clenching.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son will forever suffer from the family probate court,with out any repercussions. His bonding time with his mother has been taken away from hi. The hate he has for his father cannot turn self destructive

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tens of thousands of dollars spent on a "parenting agreement" that only gets followed when it is convenient for him. And the court does nothing to uphold said agreement, they just take more of your money to hear your case and do nothing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"the process" he kept claiming alienation and using coercive control and lying about his salary. he owns his own firm and we had to keep hiring people to disprove him.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have been alienated from a special needs child, I've lost precious time that I'll never get back, all due to lies. I haven't been able to take a vacation in 5 years due to court fees being so high

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Used my past as an excuse Refused programs and things that could have had me with my child under mandated supervision 24/7 while obtaining all case plan tasks Got my housing voutire removed and refuse a letter saying ide have a chance to get my son if they have it bak Unstable housing Pt1 denial Failed parent psych evaluation even tho I passed one 3 years prior Medicallybill due to the trauma of this removal

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It was devastating to the child, myself and family and the child is in more danger at this time so why do we have court system failing to protect kids. I was so naive to trust that the court system respects laws or has due process, it is basically the most terrifying display of an idiotical circus that I have ever seen..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Atty Larry Kelly is a dirty liar. He took an oath to be ethical and he is far from it. He makes up lies and amps up his clients making them worst abusers than they already were. Carry's no malpractice insurance because he's already been disbarred twice. He's an active alcoholic who needs mental help and AA would do him well. He send inappropriate texts and photos to his client and was arrested for DUI.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I struggled with substance abuse. My father stole custody by coercing me to sign temporary custody. My father is using my son as his second chance to be a father as he wasn't in my life as a child. Court takes extremely long to be heard and just as long to make a decision. Decisions are basically to keep doing the same thing. I've been clean since 2017.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This situation has caused long term emotional confusion, insecurity, and distress due to the sudden, unjust disruption of a primary bond at a young age, (4) compounded by years of instability and unsubstantiated, conflicting narratives that deprived us of a normal relationship for 4 years. Both my daughter, our extended family, and I continue to experience lingering grief, anxiety, and separation anxiety, with the pain of missing each other persisting through long stretches of time apart ... impacts will remain part of our emotional landscape forever. -Anonymous, Utah

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The system has separated us from my granddaughter and we had her since she was three they told her away! We have missed milestones with her and she has missed out on family time with her maternal side. He alienates her against us and there is no truth to anything he tells her. I don't even think she is allowed to speak of us. We send certified mail every week with a card and puzzles or little treats for two 1/2years since we haven't seen her. I'm sure she's not getting any of it because it's not being given to her.!!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

74 full approved Massachusetts comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Massachusetts report comes from Massachusetts respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Massachusetts — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 116 Massachusetts families reporting here are not the universe of Massachusetts families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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